



We're now in the 9th generation of gaming consoles and it's clear that games are not just child's play anymore. Gaming is

big business and it's evident from the kind of games we get these days; Grandiose blockbusters like God of War, Resident Evil, Red Dead Redemption 2, and the list goes on. These games have sort of changed the paradigm of the medium. They're detailed and evocative pieces of art that, more often than not, have been hailed as transgressive and the future of entertainment. But, what about those games that were just that, fun-filled, campy, shlocky video games? They did not have the budget that modern AAA games have and therefore had to cut corners and generally be a bit more creative when it came to designing. Think of games like Fear Effect, Godhand, Steel Harbinger and even stalwarts like Okami. The easiest way to classify them would be to call them Double-A games.

So, what exactly is a Double-A game? The easiest way to describe a Double-A game is to look at how much money was spent on it. AAA games have insane budgets for development, marketing and such but Double-A games generally had much smaller budgets and had to rely on either word of mouth or on positive reviews. A Double A game (AA) is a game that does not have the same level of quality as AAA games. They generally have a lower budget than AAA games. They try to achieve the same level of game design as AAA games but generally fall short in one or more areas such as Gameplay, Story, Graphics, Pacing, and underwhelming Set Pieces. These games are generally but not always clones of AAA franchises that just don't reach the potential set by their predecessor, some are practically multiplayer only, and some are just in an over-saturated genre. However, some of them are truly great games, just missing that special something.

If we're really getting deep into this, we could see that this trend really took shape during the PS1/PS2 era. That

generation of gaming was far ahead of its time and really took the gaming industry from a nice market to a worldwide phenomenon. The PlayStation One was the OG but the PS2 took what its older brother had created and industrialized it on a scale never seen before. A lot of franchises that are still beloved today got their start on the PS1. Games like Resident Evil, Metal Gear Solid and more helped establish the PS1 as the must-buy system of its generation. Beating out the likes of the Sega Saturn and even the Nintendo 64.

The PlayStation One was really where the idea of the Double-A game was born. With the success of Resident Evil on the console, developers began trying their hands at a bunch of titles similar to RE. We got the excellent Parasite Eve and Fear Effect as cheaper replacements. It was here the developers saw the viability of Double-A games as a financial win. If the game was successful, great. Not much was spent on it anyway and if the game failed, well, not much was spent on it anyway. This ended up being a viable strategy for some time to come and even carried over to the PS2.

The PS2 ended up being one the most successful consoles in history and one of the driving factors that helped contribute to that success were the games. Of course, you had your

